

ACADEMY OF MANAGEMENT ANNALS

Unsilencing the South: The Prophecy of the Two Birds and the Territorial Boundaries of Indigenous Management and Organization Studies

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Focus of our Review

Across the vast landscape of human ingenuity, the academic maps we use determine which theoretical landmarks we recognize and which scholarly territories we erase. While mainstream Management and Organization Studies spans a vast geography of collaboration and communal survival, the current voices dominating that literature routinely silence the very histories they claim to document. For decades, MOS has maintained a dominant, highly institutionalized narrative firmly anchored in the traditions of the Global North (Bastien, 2023). This conceptual monopoly elevates the Western corporate model as a universal default. Consequently, this leaves the discipline blind to the sophisticated organization models that thrive outside capitalist markets. With modern MOS cemented within the Anglosphere, recent scholarship, most notably Emily Salmon's *New Perspectives and Critical Insights from Indigenous Peoples' Research: A Systematic Review of Indigenous Management and Organization Literature* has begun to challenge these conceptual boundaries. Even so, global management literature still largely treats the profit-maximizing corporation as the unquestioned and ubiquitous protagonist of organizational life, thereby drawing a restrictive disciplinary map that systematically omits non-English-language academic scholarship (Banerjee, 2022).

Our project directly expands on Salmon et al's foundational work by confronting this boundary head-on. We unearth the extensive Spanish and Portuguese-language literature emerging from Latin America, a corpus largely silenced in the Global North, that theorizes organizing as an organic and living practice, that is spiritually interwoven with the protection of ancestral lands (Ibarra-Colado, 2006). The ultimate reconciliation between these two worldviews is mirrored in the Indigenous prophecy of the Eagle and the Condor. According to this five-hundred-year-old prophecy, the Eagle of the North, driven by logic and industry, will one day unite with the intuitive and heart-centered Condor of the South to ultimately restore global balance (Auger, 2015). In this synthesis, the flight of the Condor represents an intellectual awakening propelled by the dynamic body of Latin American scholarship. Unsilencing these diverse voices and this rich body of written works obliges current MOS to confront its own fixed assumptions. As a result, our review aims to expand on the field's epistemic boundaries by introducing a grounded taxonomy, repositioning Latin American Indigenous organizing as a central pillar of global organization theory.

The Value of Our Research

In order to construct a more inclusive global framework for Indigenous MOS, our project builds on the comprehensive systematic literature review conducted by Emily Salmon, Juan Francisco Chavez and Matthew Murphy (2023). Their study provides an invaluable service to the academic community by aggregating and analyzing a highly dispersed body of Indigenous management

research rooted in the Global North, spanning an extensive 90-year publication lifecycle (Salmon et al., 2023). Salmon et al. developed a taxonomy that categorized Indigenous literature into two distinct thematic dimensions: internal dynamics through ‘Indigenous ways of being’, focusing on the operational realities of collective action and community entrepreneurship, and ‘Indigenous relating,’ which traces the complex structural interactions that occur when Indigenous peoples engage with external forces such as settler populations or Western corporations (Salmon et al., 2023). Despite the undeniable value of this baseline, the authors restricted their data collection to English-dominant indexes. Therefore, the resulting taxonomy from their review was tied to rigid linguistic borders, limiting Anglophone scholars’ understanding of how Indigenous communities and with their distinct sense of organizing function elsewhere in the world.

Mainstream management frameworks often misinterpret and overlook the unique setting of the Latin world, ignoring how Iberian colonial rule entrenched asymmetric power structures across the Global South. This analytical blind spot prevents scholars from accurately evaluating aggressive resource extractivism and the legal conflicts surrounding consultation rights in this part of the Globe (Banerjee 2011). Similarly, standard management strategies universalize individual property rights and shareholder profit maximization, treating these Western constructs as neutral defaults rather than culturally specific legal mechanisms (Orozco & Poonamallee, 2014). This narrow focus systematically excludes the viable solidarity economies of Latin America that operate successfully outside the orthodox capital market (Gonzalez A. L., 2021). Our review will therefore use Salmon et al.’s taxonomy as a flexible bedrock for theoretical expansion within Indigenous MOS, integrating conceptual categories that emerge directly from the Spanish- and Portuguese-language literature of Latin America. Essentially, this uncovers the final goal of our review, to push global management theory beyond its insular provincial criteria by replacing a transactional view of corporate strategy within a superstructure where human collaboration binds itself to the fractured socioenvironmental landscapes of the Global South (George et al, 2016).

Trajectory of the Review

Shifting the analytical anchor from the Global North to Latin American Indigenous organizations introduces a transformative model that can restructure global management scholarship. To ingrain this intervention, our first pillar explores the ontological inseparability of territory through Indigenous ways of knowing, defining land as a living participant in organizational life that carries profound spiritual value throughout Latin American literature, where territory functions as the vital matrix for any collaborative organizing (Bastien et al. 2023). Empirical studies of forest enterprises in Oaxaca, Mexico, and ancestral water management regimes in the Peruvian Andes clearly demonstrate this operational reality, proving that ecological governance and collective action remain inextricably bound (Antinori & Bray, 2005). Additionally, organizational literature of Ecuador and Bolivia establishes that an enterprise cannot be decoupled from the spiritual and ecological health of its surrounding Indigenous ecosystem

(Medrano, 2021). Coffee and cacao cooperatives across the Bolivian Altiplano operationalize this principle by enforcing strict production caps rooted in traditional ecological knowledge that deliberately allow soil regeneration and conserve biodiversity. These Andean and Amazonian communities and cooperatives align their harvesting schedules and even their labour allocation entirely with collective identity, yielding a documented and highly functional model of sustainable resource governance.

Our second pillar addresses the structural reality of coloniality by analyzing the institutional exclusion that shapes corporate-community interactions and examining historical asset dispossession. At the heart of this dimension, coloniality is understood as an ongoing structural logic that weaponizes state legal mechanisms to systematically invalidate communal land tenure and exclude Indigenous voices from resource governance (Couto et al. 2021). We examine this through two distinct contemporary operational examples in the Global South. Specifically, nineteenth-century disentailment policies, exemplified by the Ley Lerdo of 1856 in Mexico and the *decretos bolivarianos* in Colombia, Peru, and Ecuador during the 1820s, which laid the institutional groundwork for contemporary structural violence. Through these sweeping legal decrees, post-colonial states actively dismantled collective Indigenous landholdings, transforming previously sovereign Indigenous territories into state-owned concessions (Knowlton, 1976; Jacobsen, 1993). The second example highlights current strategies for successful Indigenous territorial defense and resistance. This pillar examines the legal conflicts and physical confrontations surrounding consultation rights, tracking how Indigenous communities engage in autonomous territorial defence. The *Guardia Indígena* (Indigenous Guard) of the Regional Indigenous Council of Cauca (CRIC) in Colombia best illustrates this approach, exercising territorial control to protect communal resources from external Settler threats (Ulloa, 2016).

Lastly, our final pillar introduces pluralistic models of solidarity economics that operate successfully outside Western capital markets, that define economic activity as explicitly subordinated to Indigenous and regional ecological and cultural reproduction, deliberately replacing the extractivist capitalism with architectures of reciprocity and collective welfare (Li, 2025). Latin American Indigenous literature presents empirical evidence of these alternative operational architectures, including community-led cooperatives and communal enterprises, in which local kinship networks underpin economic activity. These systems maintain long-term organizational viability by prioritizing collective resilience, actively reinforcing oral and written traditions across generations (Li, 2025). We examine this model through specifically using the two following examples: firstly, in the Andes, this pillar revitalizes reciprocal labour exchange systems such as *minka* and *ayni*. Community enterprises in Peru leverage these practices to execute large-scale infrastructure projects without relying on wage labour or incurring monetary debt (Mayer, 2002). Similarly, in Brazil, the collective mobilization practices, termed *mutirão* observed in Indigenous agroforestry networks demonstrate how communities measure economic

value by the density of preserved ancestral forests and long-term community stability (Fajardo, 2020). Through these functional models, the regional literature delivers a rigorous taxonomic vocabulary for organizations that deliberately favour socio-ecological continuity over profit maximization.

Scope and Source Methodology

In order to capture these specific regional paradigms with complete scholarly integrity, our project employs a systematic literature review to retrieve peer-reviewed Indigenous scholarship across Spanish and Portuguese-language sources based on Salmon's own methodology. Because the research on Southern Indigenous organizing is inherently interdisciplinary, our sourcing strategy targets multidisciplinary databases across the social sciences and human geography. This expansive cross-referencing practice overcomes two major structural channels of academic exclusion: the linguistic isolation of English-only indexes and the disciplinary insularity of standard business databases (Piekkari et al. 2020). Insights into Southern organizations rarely appear in conventional business journals; instead, they appear in specialized sociological and legal volumes that document active Indigenous collective living. For instance, critical assessments of the *sistema de cargos*, a civic-religious governance hierarchy that structures Southern institutional leadership, frequently appear in anthropological journals and rarely in mainstream management outlets (Cancian, 1965). Similarly, evaluations of *ejido* resource governance, which relies on collective land ownership and communal assemblies, dominate agricultural sociology and environmental law periodicals, again largely bypassing strategic management publications (Rodrigues, 2003; Ostrom, 1990).

Moreover, our database architecture pairs global indexes with specialized regional platforms to build a comprehensive dataset, directly mirroring and further building upon the foundation; systematic methodology established by Salmon et al. While global business repositories such as *EBSCO Business Source*, *ProQuest ABI/INFORM*, and *Emerald Insight* capture mainstream managerial discourses, coupling them with the primary Latin American databases: *SciELO*, *Redalyc*, *Latindex*, and *Dialnet*, roots the search in localized scholarship. This will aid in our expansion of parameters to bridge the linguistic gaps of English-indexes. In addition, platforms like *SciELO* and *Redalyc* host a vast repository of open-access and peer-reviewed studies that circumvent traditional corporate publishing paywalls, unlocking vital research from Brazil alongside deep historical analyses from Andean academic circles. Our search protocol isolates these localized paradigms from our selected databases through targeted metadata queries across titles, abstracts, and keywords. The primary search strings drive this extraction through descriptor combinations in both Spanish and Portuguese, pairing terms such as *pueblos indigenas* and *comunidades indigenas* with operational management concepts, including *gobernanza*, *gestion*, *economia solidaria*, and *cooperativismo*, among others. These conceptual pairings bridge the semantic gap separating Western administrative terminology from Southern collective practices. To preserve distinct regional variations, our protocol avoids generic terminology by

targeting four major Indigenous nations across two macro-regional ecosystems: the *Quechua* and *Aymara* peoples of the Andean Highlands and the *Guarani* and *Mapuche* peoples of the Lowland and Southern Cone regions. Coupling these ethnonyms with precise structural qualifiers effectively pinpoints where ancestral customs intersect with national regulatory pressures.

Content Criteria

Following the execution of this targeted search protocol, the raw literature undergoes a strict evaluation phase and screening process. Eligible articles must feature peer-reviewed analysis published in Spanish or Portuguese that centers on traditional communal enterprises or regional ethnonyms as a core pillar of their empirical or theoretical architecture. These parameters are verified via full-text analysis of each article, bypassing translated metadata or secondary English database indexing. Studies on general rural development or non-specific peasant movements are excluded unless they explicitly analyze Indigenous organizational realities. For every validated article, an intensive full-text keyword verification scans for regional contextual markers, such as *comunal* and *desamortización*. As an example, tracking the presence of nineteenth-century disentailment policies identifies the specific institutional trauma of state-enforced privatization, revealing how contemporary Indigenous communal enterprises resist ongoing asset dispossession (Maclean et al. 2016). Final data points are sorted by database provenance and specific ethnonym before mapping them onto Salmon et al.'s structure. This process generates a dialectical dialogue between the established conceptual baseline and the unique characteristics of Southern literature, providing the empirical leverage needed to decenter mainstream management theory.

In summary, our systematic review integrates the structurally grounded realities of Southern Indigenous organizations into global scholarship, honouring the spirit of the ancient prophecy of the Eagle and the Condor. Formalizing the Southern corpus within the standards of global organization theory, this project creates the intellectual airspace necessary for their shared flight. Specifically, our cross-linguistic approach acts as a direct theoretical expansion that complements Salmon et al.'s work, while definitively challenging the discipline to look beyond its traditional Anglo-centric boundaries. When the Eagle and the Condor finally share the sky, organization theory breaks free from the restrictive corporate bottom line to embrace a truly globally representative paradigm. By centralizing the organizational logic of the Global South, this shift replaces the velocity of wealth extraction and capital accumulation with a deeper metric of corporate and community brilliance: the quiet, ancestral rhythm of Indigenous intergenerational survival.

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